Project Management Framework Guide

A phased, PMI-based and Agile-executed delivery model for software projects.

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Version 3.0

1. Executive Summary

Every project runs through eight phases, and each phase ends with a written approval that the next phase cannot start without. The model separates what is uncertain (scope, design, cost) from what is predictable (build, test, release), so the client prices real work rather than assumptions.

Cost is fixed only after scope and design are approved. Until then, the client sees an indicative range and pays small, fixed fees for the phases that remove uncertainty.

The client receives	The client commits to
A signed scope document before any design starts	One decision-maker who can approve in writing
Approved designs before development cost is fixed	Feedback within 24 hours
A fixed price built from real estimates	Milestone payments on schedule
Working features demonstrated every sprint	Access, content and third-party accounts on time
A weekly written status with risks and decisions needed	Changes raised through change control, not chat
A tested, documented product and a warranty period	Acceptance testing inside the agreed window

Three rules hold the model together:

- No design starts before the Scope Definition Document is approved.

- No development starts before the plan, cost and contract are approved and the first payment is received.
- No change is built before its impact on time and cost is analyzed and approved in writing.

Section 2 defines roles and gates, Section 3 shows the whole lifecycle, Sections 4 to 11 detail each phase, Sections 12 to 14 cover the controls that run across phases, and Sections 15 and 16 cover commercial terms and sign-off. Templates are listed in Appendix A.

2. Operating Model: Principles, Roles and Gates

The model runs on seven principles, clear decision rights and six approval gates, and adapting it to a project changes the weight of the process, never the gates.

Principles

1. **Scope before design.** Nobody designs what has not been defined and signed.
2. **Cost follows design.** Development is priced only when designs make the work visible.
3. **Written approvals.** An approval counts when the authorized client contact gives it in writing.
4. **Small increments.** Work is delivered and demonstrated in short cycles, so errors surface early.
5. **Early risk visibility.** Risks are logged in Phase 1, reviewed weekly and reported before they become issues.
6. **One source of truth.** One tracker, one versioned document set, one channel for decisions.
7. **Proportionate process.** Ceremonies and documents scale with project size; gates do not.

Roles and decision rights

On small projects one person can hold several roles, but the accountability column does not change.

Activity	Client contact	Project Manager	Designer	Tech lead	QA
Scope approval	A	R	I	C	I

Activity	Client contact	Project Manager	Designer	Tech lead	QA
Design approval	A	R	R	C	I
Estimate and plan	A	R	C	R	C
Sprint delivery	C	A	C	R	R
Change requests	A	R	C	C	I
UAT sign-off	A	R	I	C	R
Go-live decision	A	R	I	R	C

R = does the work. A = accountable and approves. C = consulted. I = informed.

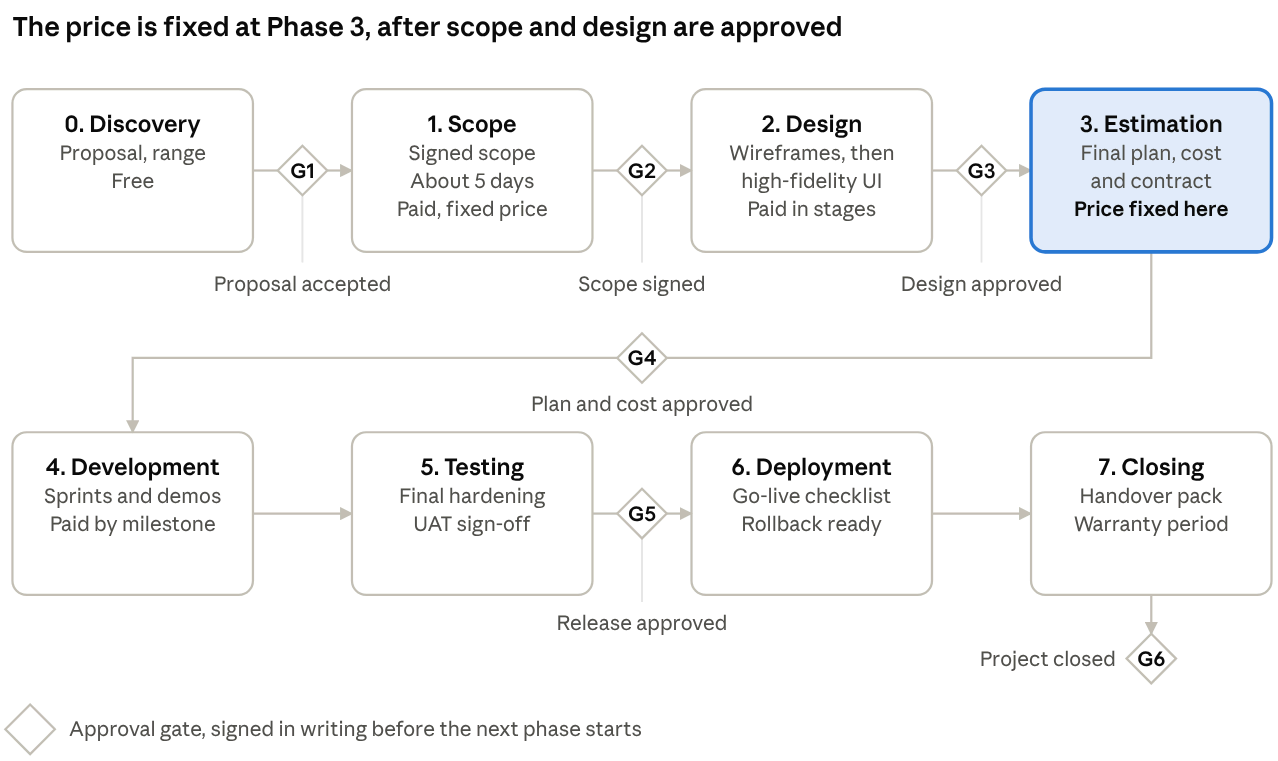
Approval gates

Gate	Closes	Evidence required	Approver
G1 Proposal accepted	Phase 0	Initial proposal accepted, first 50% of the scope fee paid	Client sponsor
G2 Scope signed	Phase 1	Signed Scope Definition Document, prioritized feature list, WBS	Client sponsor
G3 Design approved	Phase 2	Approved wireframes and approved high-fidelity UI	Client sponsor
G4 Plan and cost approved	Phase 3	Signed contract, development plan, final cost, first milestone paid	Client sponsor
G5 Release approved	Phase 5	UAT sign-off, exit criteria met, go-live checklist complete	Client sponsor
G6 Project closed	Phase 7	Handover pack delivered, final report, closure sign-off	Client sponsor

Inside Phase 4, each sprint demo is a smaller acceptance point that releases the matching milestone.

3. Lifecycle at a Glance

The project moves through eight phases and six approval gates, and the price becomes fixed only at Phase 3.



project lifecycle · 8 phases, 6 approval gates

Gates G1 to G6 and the evidence each needs are listed in Section 2. Inside Phase 4, each sprint demo releases the matching milestone payment.

4. Phase 0: Pre-Sales, Discovery and Initial Proposal

Phase 0 is free and ends when the client accepts an initial proposal, or when both sides decide not to proceed. The goal is to protect both parties from investing in a project that does not fit.

Qualify the opportunity

Before the meeting, the PM checks six points. Two or more weak answers are a reason to decline or to reshape the offer.

- A clear business problem, not only a feature wish list
- A named decision-maker
- A budget range that is plausible for the described scope
- A realistic timeline
- Technology and domain the team can deliver

- Willingness to pay for Phase 1

Discovery meeting

One meeting, prepared with a written agenda. The PM sends discovery notes within 24 hours and the client confirms them.

Topic	Questions to answer
Business goals	What outcome defines success, and how will it be measured?
Users	Who uses it, how often and on which devices?
Scope	Which features are essential? Is there an existing system, design or code?
Constraints	What drives the deadline? What is the budget range? Any compliance or language needs?
Integrations	Payments, ERP, maps, messaging, other third-party services
Stakeholders	Who decides, who approves, who is affected?
Risks	What has failed before, and what worries the client most?

Indicative estimate

The PM builds a rough order of magnitude with the tech lead and the designer. It lists modules, gives a low and high figure for each, and adds a contingency (suggested 20 to 40% at this stage, because detail is thin). It is shared as a range for budget and timeline, clearly marked non-binding.

Initial proposal

The proposal is short and contains:

- Client needs, restated in the client's own terms
- Assumptions
- Initial scope and a first out-of-scope list
- Proposed phases and approval gates

- Indicative budget and timeline range
- The Phase 1 fixed fee and what it produces
- Validity period (suggested: 14 days) and the next step

Gate G1: proceed or stop

The client accepts the proposal and pays the first 50% of the Phase 1 fee. The PM records the decision and opens the project in the tracker. If sales and delivery are different people, a handover checklist records what was promised, what was shared, who the contacts are and which risks were heard.

5. Phase 1: Scope Definition and Planning (Paid)

Phase 1 turns an idea into a signed blueprint in about five working days, at a fixed fee, before any design starts. It aligns the parties, reduces risk and gives design and estimation a reliable base.

Five-day plan

Day	Focus	Output
1	Kickoff, stakeholders, goals and success criteria	Stakeholder register, draft RACI, goals and KPIs
2	Requirements sessions on users, business flows and user flows	Flow diagrams, draft requirement list
3	Requirements sessions on features, integrations and non-functional needs	Feature list v1, integration list, non-functional requirements
4	Prioritization (MVP versus later), WBS, risks and assumptions	Prioritized feature list, WBS, risk register, assumptions log
5	Client review of the draft and corrections	Scope Definition Document issued for signature

These are days of working effort. The calendar stretches when the client is slow to respond, which is why Section 14 sets response times.

What the Scope Definition Document contains

1. Business context and goals
2. Success criteria and KPIs
3. Users and roles
4. In-scope features by module, each with acceptance criteria
5. Explicit out-of-scope list
6. MVP and later phases
7. Integrations and third-party services
8. Non-functional requirements: performance, security, languages, devices
9. Assumptions, constraints and dependencies
10. Initial risks
11. Glossary
12. Approval record

Prioritization

Features are ranked Must, Should, Could or Won't (this release). A common rule of thumb keeps Must items to about 60% of total effort, which leaves room for Should items and contingency. The MVP is the set of Must items, agreed with the client in the workshop.

Deliverables and acceptance

- Scope Definition Document (signed)
- Detailed Feature List (prioritized)
- Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)
- Assumptions and Constraints Log
- Initial Risk Register
- Stakeholder Register and Communication Plan

The phase is complete when every in-scope feature has acceptance criteria, every assumption has an owner and the out-of-scope list has been reviewed with the client.

Price and payment

The fee is fixed and covers meetings, documentation, stakeholder alignment and review. It is built from the estimated hours per day, the number of days, the scope complexity and the level of collaboration required.

Illustrative example: 2 hours per day × 5 days = 10 hours, multiplied by the applicable hourly rate, gives the fixed fee. The fee is confirmed in writing before the phase starts and changes only if the agreed assumptions change, such as more sessions, more stakeholders or a wider scope. Any change is agreed before the extra work begins.

- 50% before the phase starts
- 50% on delivery of the Scope Definition Document

Gate G2 and scope control

No design work begins until the Scope Definition Document is reviewed and approved in writing. Any requirement not documented and approved here is out of scope and goes through change control (Section 12).

> This phase ensures that all future work is built on a clear, validated foundation, saving time, cost and rework during design and development.

6. Phase 2: UI/UX Design

Phase 2 produces approved designs in two stages, wireframes first and high-fidelity UI second, so structural feedback arrives before visual polish. Each stage has its own written approval.

Workflow

1. Design kickoff: review the scope document, user flows, references and brand assets.
2. Low-fidelity wireframes for every in-scope screen.
3. Client review and written low-fidelity approval.
4. High-fidelity UI with a style guide: colors, typography, components and states.
5. Clickable prototype of the key flows.
6. Client review, iteration and written high-fidelity approval.
7. Developer handoff: specifications, assets and component library.

Feedback protocol

- The client sends one consolidated list per round, through the single point of contact.
- The PM sorts each item within one working day into a revision, a clarification or a change request.

- Two minor revisions per phase are included.
- Conflicting feedback goes to the sponsor to decide.

Deliverables

- Approved wireframes
- Final UI designs
- Clickable prototype
- Style guide and component library
- Developer handoff package
- Screen inventory mapped to scope features

Developer handoff checklist

- [ ] Every screen maps to a feature in the WBS
- [ ] All states are designed: empty, loading, error and success
- [ ] Responsive behavior is defined for each supported device size
- [ ] Assets are exported and named consistently
- [ ] The tech lead has walked through the designs with the designer

Price and payment

Project management is a fixed fee for design coordination, reviews and alignment, typically about 25% of the designer's total effort. The design fee comes from the designer's detailed estimate and depends on the number of screens, their complexity and the iterations expected.

- 50% before starting
- 25% after low-fidelity approval
- 25% after high-fidelity approval

Gate G3

No estimate is finalized and no development starts before high-fidelity approval. Changes after approval follow change control (Section 12).

7. Phase 3: Estimation, Cost Finalization and Contract

Phase 3 fixes the development price only after designs are approved, because that is the first point where the work is visible enough to estimate fairly. The result is a single fixed project cost built from real data.

Method

1. Technical breakdown: convert screens and features into tasks by layer, such as backend, web or mobile front end, integrations, DevOps and QA.
2. Bottom-up estimates from the developers who will build it. Uncertain items get a three-point estimate.
3. Non-coding effort added by the PM: project management (typically 10 to 15%), QA, DevOps, documentation, UAT support and rework.
4. Risk review and a contingency allowance (suggested 10 to 30%, depending on uncertainty).
5. Timeline: effort divided by team capacity, adjusted for dependencies and client review time.
6. Review by the tech lead and the PM for gaps, and a comparison with similar past projects.

The three-point estimate for an item, where O is optimistic, M most likely and P pessimistic:

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E = \frac{O + 4M + P}{6}
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Fixed price build-up

Cost line	Basis	Status at approval
PM planning	Effort in this phase	Fixed
Development	Developer estimates by module	Fixed
QA and UAT support	Test plan effort	Fixed, included
Deployment	Release effort and environment setup	Estimated, then fixed in the price

Cost line	Basis	Status at approval
Closing	Handover, documentation, retrospective	Estimated, then fixed in the price
Contingency	Risk-based allowance	Shown openly
Third-party costs	Hosting, licenses, app store fees, SMS and email, gateway fees	Listed separately, paid by the client

Estimated lines such as deployment and closing are consolidated into the fixed price, and the allowance is stated openly, so the client sees what the fixed price contains.

Deliverables

- Development Plan: milestones, sprint structure and team
- Final Timeline
- Final Cost Breakdown
- Contract or Statement of Work
- Kickoff readiness checklist

Development kickoff readiness

- [ ] Contract signed and first milestone paid
- [ ] Plan, timeline and cost approved in writing
- [ ] Team assigned and available
- [ ] Tracker, repositories and environments set up
- [ ] Third-party accounts and credentials requested from the client
- [ ] Communication plan confirmed
- [ ] Definition of Done agreed

Gate G4

No development starts before full written approval of the plan, timeline and cost, the signed contract and receipt of the first payment.

8. Phase 4: Development and Execution

Phase 4 delivers the product in short sprints (suggested: two weeks), with a client demo at the end of each so that misunderstandings are caught while they are cheap to fix.

Sprint cadence

Ceremony	When	Participants	Output
Sprint planning	Start of sprint	PM, team, client contact for priorities	Sprint goal and committed items
Daily follow-up	Daily, 15 minutes	Team and PM	Blockers surfaced
Backlog refinement	Mid-sprint	PM, tech lead, client contact	Next sprint items ready, with acceptance criteria
Sprint review and demo	End of sprint	Team and client	Features accepted or returned, with feedback
Retrospective	After the review	Team	Improvement actions
Weekly status report	Weekly	PM to client	Written status (Section 13)

Definition of Done

A feature is done when all of the following are true:

- It matches the approved design and acceptance criteria
- Peer code review has passed
- Unit and functional tests have passed
- QA has verified it in a staging environment
- No critical or high-severity defect is open against it
- It has been demonstrated to the client
- Documentation is updated

Quality practices

- Version control with branch and pull request rules
- Automated build and tests on each merge where feasible
- Separate development, staging and production environments
- Security basics reviewed: access control and data handling
- Performance checked on the key user flows

The PM's operating rhythm

- Track burndown and velocity, and compare them with the plan every week
- Keep every task traceable to the WBS and the approved scope
- Review the risk register weekly (Section 12)
- Clear blockers within one working day or escalate them
- Shield the team from ad-hoc requests by routing them through change control
- Record decisions in the tracker and update the plan after every approved change

Milestones and payment

Milestones are defined in the Development Plan. Each one groups a set of features with an amount, and becomes payable when the client accepts those features. Suggested acceptance window: five working days after the demo, with a reminder before silence is treated as acceptance.

9. Phase 5: Testing and UAT

Testing runs inside every sprint, and Phase 5 is the final hardening window that ends with the client's signed acceptance. Nothing is released without it.

Test levels

Level	Owner	Purpose
Unit and integration	Developers	Logic works and components work together
Functional and regression	QA	Features meet acceptance criteria and earlier features still work

Level	Owner	Purpose
Cross-device and browser	QA	Supported devices and browsers behave correctly
Security and performance checks	Tech lead and QA	Basic protection and speed on key flows
User acceptance testing (UAT)	Client	The product meets the business need in real use

Defect severity

Severity	Definition	Release rule
Critical	System down, data loss or security flaw, no workaround	Fixed before release, worked on immediately
High	Core feature broken, no practical workaround	Fixed before release
Medium	Feature impaired, reasonable workaround exists	Fixed, or accepted in writing by the client
Low	Cosmetic or minor	Backlog, or fixed if time allows

Response times per severity are set in the Development Plan.

UAT process

1. The PM and the client agree the UAT scope, scripts and window (suggested: five working days).
2. QA prepares test data and a UAT environment.
3. The client runs the scripts and logs issues in the tracker.
4. The team triages daily, fixes and retests.
5. The client signs the UAT acceptance.

Exit criteria for Gate G5 (part 1)

- All in-scope features tested against their acceptance criteria
- Zero open critical or high defects

- Medium and low defects fixed or accepted in writing
- Regression suite passed
- UAT sign-off signed

Deliverables are the test report, the defect log and the UAT sign-off.

10. Phase 6: Deployment and Go-Live

Phase 6 releases the product through a checked go-live process, with a rollback plan ready and the team on hand afterward. Most go-live problems come from missing accounts and credentials, so these are prepared early.

Production prerequisites

- Hosting and infrastructure
- Domain, DNS and SSL certificates
- Email, SMS and notification providers
- Live payment gateway credentials
- Analytics, monitoring and backup services
- App store developer accounts and store listings, where mobile apps are in scope

Suggested practice: accounts are created in the client's name so ownership is clear from day one.

Go-live readiness checklist

- [ ] UAT signed and no critical or high defects open
- [ ] Production environment configured and verified
- [ ] Data migration tested, if applicable
- [ ] Backups taken and a restore tested
- [ ] Rollback plan written and rehearsed
- [ ] Release notes and client communication prepared
- [ ] Monitoring and alerts active
- [ ] Support contacts and roles confirmed for release day
- [ ] Client go-live approval received (Gate G5, part 2)

Release steps

1. Confirm go or no-go with the client.
2. Freeze changes.
3. Deploy to production using the release checklist.
4. Smoke-test the critical flows.
5. Announce go-live.
6. Monitor. If the smoke tests fail, roll back as planned.

Hypercare

For the first working days after go-live (suggested: five), the team monitors the system daily, triages issues quickly and sends the client a short daily update.

Deliverables and payment

The deliverables are the live product and the deployment documentation. The final milestone payment is due on go-live acceptance.

11. Phase 7: Closing, Handover and Warranty

Phase 7 transfers everything the client needs to own and run the product, and closes the project formally so that nothing is left open.

Handover pack

- Source code repository access and branch structure
- Inventory of environments and credentials, transferred securely
- Architecture overview and deployment guide
- User and admin guides, and API documentation where relevant
- Test report and known-issues list
- List of third-party accounts and who owns each
- Design files and style guide

Closing activities

1. Handover session with the client team, with training where agreed.

2. Final report: scope delivered against plan, timeline and cost against plan, approved changes, issues and how they were resolved, quality results and recommendations.
3. Retrospective with the team and, ideally, the client.
4. Lessons learned recorded and shared.
5. Cost reconciliation and final invoice.
6. Team released and project artifacts archived.
7. Closure sign-off by the client (Gate G6).

Warranty and support

Defects in delivered, approved scope are fixed at no charge during a warranty period (suggested: 30 days after go-live). The warranty does not cover new features, changes to approved scope, failures of third-party services or misuse.

After the warranty, support continues under a separate agreement, either a monthly retainer or time and materials, or through change control.

Relationship follow-up

- A check-in call about 30 days after go-live
- A short client satisfaction survey
- Permission to use the project as a case study
- A discussion of the next phase or roadmap items

12. Project Controls: Risk, Issues, Change and Scope

Four controls keep a fixed price and Agile delivery compatible: risk management, issue escalation, change control and scope protection.

Risk management

The register is created in Phase 1 and reviewed every week. Each risk is scored as likelihood times impact, each rated 1 to 3, and scores of 6 and 9 are reviewed with the sponsor.

1. Identify risks in Phase 1 and at every sprint planning.
2. Assess likelihood and impact.
3. Choose a response: avoid, mitigate, transfer or accept.

4. Assign an owner and a due date for the response.
5. Review weekly and report the top risks to the client.

The register records the risk ID, description, likelihood, impact, score, response, owner and status. Typical software risks to watch:

- Unclear or changing requirements
- Slow client feedback or approvals
- Third-party API or app store delays
- Key person unavailable
- Scope creep through informal requests
- Under-estimated integrations

Issue escalation

An issue is a risk that has happened. Suggested response times:

Level	Who handles it	Trigger	Target
1	Tech lead and PM	Blocks a task or sprint item	Resolved within 1 working day
2	PM and client contact	Affects the plan or needs a client decision	Decision within 2 working days
3	Sponsors	Threatens scope, timeline or cost	Decision within 3 working days

Change control

Included: up to two minor revisions per phase. A minor revision adjusts an already approved item without changing its function, flow or structure, such as copy, colors, spacing or small layout tweaks.

Not included: new features, major changes, and changes to approved scope, flows or integrations.

1. The client submits the change request form.
2. The PM logs it with an ID.
3. Impact analysis on scope, time, cost and risk (suggested: within two working days).

4. The client approves or rejects in writing.
5. The team implements, and the PM updates the scope document, plan and budget.

The form records the ID, date, requester, description, reason, affected items, effort, timeline and cost impact, risks, decision, approver and date. In Agile execution, an item of equal effort can be swapped for an unstarted one at no extra cost. A critical defect on a live system is fixed first and documented afterward.

Rule: no change is implemented without full written approval.

Scope protection

Any work not explicitly defined in the approved Scope Definition Document is out of scope. Third-party costs such as hosting, licenses, app store fees, messaging services and gateway fees are excluded unless they appear in the Final Cost Breakdown.

A changed assumption in the assumptions log triggers re-estimation. When someone asks for "one small addition" in a call or chat, the PM logs it and routes it through change control.

13. Communication and Reporting

The client sees progress, risks and the decisions needed every week, in writing, so nobody learns about a problem for the first time at a demo.

Cadence

Forum	Frequency	Audience	Purpose
Kickoff	Start of the engagement and of Phases 1 and 4	All stakeholders	Align goals, roles and working rules
Weekly sync	Weekly, 30 minutes	Client contact, PM, tech lead	Progress, decisions, risks
Sprint review	Every sprint	Client stakeholders and team	Demo and acceptance
Phase gate review	End of each phase	Sponsor and PM	Approve or correct before the next phase

Forum	Frequency	Audience	Purpose
Sponsor update	Monthly or at milestones, for larger projects	Sponsor	Budget, timeline and risk overview

Weekly report content

1. Overall health for scope, timeline and cost
2. Work completed this week
3. Work planned for next week
4. Milestone progress
5. Top risks and issues, each with an owner
6. Decisions or inputs needed from the client, with due dates
7. Pending change requests
8. Effort and budget used against plan

Health status

Status	Meaning	Action
Green	On track, no help needed	Continue
Amber	At risk, but recoverable within the PM's control	PM presents a recovery plan in the report
Red	Off track, a sponsor decision is needed	Escalate within one working day

Working rules

- One agreed channel for decisions, so nothing is lost in informal chats
- Meeting notes and decisions sent within 24 hours
- One shared document set with version numbers
- A shared tracking board the client can open at any time

14. Client Responsibilities and Timeline Dependencies

Delivery dates hold only when the client answers quickly and decides clearly, so these duties are part of the agreement.

Client responsibilities

- Give feedback within 24 hours
- Assign a single point of contact with authority to approve
- Give formal approvals on time (suggested: within three working days)
- Provide clear requirements and answer questions promptly
- Supply content, brand assets and test data
- Provide access to systems and APIs the project depends on
- Create or authorize the required third-party accounts
- Attend demos and take part in UAT
- Pay milestones on schedule

What delays cause

All timelines depend on client responsiveness and approval speed. Suggested consequences:

Situation	Effect
Feedback up to 5 working days late	Timeline shifts by the same period, and the team may be rescheduled
Feedback more than 5 working days late	The project pauses, and restart depends on team availability
Missing content or credentials	Dependent tasks wait and the timeline shifts
Late payment	Work pauses until payment is received
Scope change	Impact analysis and a revised timeline through change control

The PM reports each client dependency in the weekly report, so the client sees the cost of a delay before it happens.

15. Commercial Terms

Fees are fixed per phase and paid in stages tied to approvals, so the client pays for verified progress.

Payment schedule

Phase	Fee type	Payment schedule
0. Discovery and proposal	Free	None
1. Scope Definition	Fixed, PM effort	50% before the phase, 50% on delivery of the Scope Definition Document
2. UI/UX Design	PM fixed fee (about 25% of design effort) plus design estimate	50% before the phase, 25% after low-fidelity approval, 25% after high-fidelity approval
3. Estimation and contract	PM planning fee	Agreed before the phase starts
4. Development	Fixed total from the approved estimate	Milestone-based, on accepted feature delivery
5 to 7. Testing, deployment, closing	Included in the fixed price	Final milestone on go-live acceptance

Pricing mechanics

- Hourly rates by role are listed in the contract
- PM effort is shown as its own line
- Contingency is visible, not hidden in rates
- Third-party costs are passed through at cost and paid by the client
- Currency and taxes are stated on every estimate
- Estimates stay valid for a stated period (suggested: 30 days)

Terms to confirm in the contract

- Invoice payment period (suggested: seven days)
- Work pauses when payment is late
- Source code and designs transfer to the client on full payment
- Third-party and open-source licenses stay with their owners
- Both parties keep project information confidential
- If the project is cancelled, completed work is billed and completed deliverables are handed over once payment is received
- Warranty terms as in Section 11
- Dispute path: sponsors first, then the process in the contract

This guide is not a contract. A lawyer should review the final contract wording, including liability and governing law.

16. Agreement and Sign-Off

Proceeding with a project means both parties accept the defined scope, the payment structure, the delivery model and the change control process. A signed contract or Statement of Work remains the binding document for each project.

	Client	Service provider
Name		
Title		
Signature		
Date		

Appendix A: Templates and Artifacts by Phase

Every phase has a named artifact set, so nothing depends on memory or goodwill.

Phase	Artifacts and templates	Owner
0. Discovery	Qualification checklist, discovery agenda and notes, rough estimate sheet, initial proposal, handover checklist	PM

Phase	Artifacts and templates	Owner
1. Scope Definition	Scope Definition Document, feature list with priorities, WBS, assumptions log, risk register, stakeholder register, RACI, communication plan	PM
2. Design	Wireframes, UI designs, prototype, style guide, handoff package, feedback log	Designer, PM
3. Estimation	Estimation workbook, development plan, timeline, cost breakdown, contract or SOW, kickoff readiness checklist	PM, tech lead
4. Development	Sprint backlog, sprint goals, demo notes, weekly report, decision log, Definition of Done	PM, team
5. Testing and UAT	Test plan, test cases, defect log, UAT scripts, test report, UAT sign-off	QA, PM
6. Deployment	Release checklist, deployment and rollback plan, release notes, go-live approval, deployment documentation	Tech lead, PM
7. Closing	Handover pack, final report, lessons learned, closure sign-off, warranty terms	PM
All phases	Risk register, change request form and log, weekly status report, approval log	PM

Appendix B: Review Notes (remove before sharing with clients)

Version 3.0 reorganizes the guide from a phase-by-phase narrative into an operating model, eight phases, shared controls and commercial terms.

Structural changes from version 2.0

Version 2.0	Version 3.0	Reason
Principles inside "My Approach"	Section 2 holds principles, roles and gates	Decision rights and approval evidence are visible up front
Policies after the last phase	Sections 12 to 14 hold controls shared by all phases	Risk, change and client duties apply from Phase 1, not only at the end

Version 2.0	Version 3.0	Reason
Cost and payment repeated in each phase	Each phase keeps its own terms, and Section 15 holds the full schedule	One place to check what is paid when
Flow listed as a single line	Section 3 draws the lifecycle with its gates	Order and gates are read at a glance
No template list	Appendix A lists artifacts by phase	Delivery teams know what to produce